

Board of curiosities

If you—or a relative or friend—have some old household fixtures, make a play board of the safe objects. Use a sanded piece of MDF with no sharp corners. Recycle an old door handle, door bell, and security door chain and attach them firmly to the board so they are securely in place and your baby can safely turn the handle, press the bell and try to say “Ding-dong,” and put the chain in the holder. If you have an old hinge, screw one half of the hinge to a piece of thin sanded wood with a door knob stuck on and attach the other half of the hinge to the board to make a flap for him to lift. He will enjoy thinking about how to push, pull, and lift these different objects. Watch him as he plays to make sure he doesn’t chew or suck the board.

